

Also note that there's an option which you can check to allocate all the disk space right away. This will improve the performance but lock you out on all the space you have decided! Also, allocating all the space takes time!

You're at a final screen where you can customise the hardware further by clicking the "Customize Hardware..." button or just click "Finish". You can also determine whether or not you want to power on the virtual machine right after creation.

If you did not select the installation media earlier, don't start it right away. If you have the media, you can select it by clicking the hardware customization button and selecting the media in the new window that opens up (you should click on CD/DVD option for that) and then finalize the settings before you start the virtual machine.

That's it. Your virtual machine is ready to be run on your system! You can now install your desired OS and start working on it. Just click on the start button - it looks like a play button, a triangle which points to the right, and you would be installing the OS.

Features

VMware Workstation is probably the most feature-rich virtualization application you can find for a desktop. It has a long list of features and we're going to talk about the most useful ones here.

- ▶ **VMware tools (guest add-ons):** VMware calls its guest add-ons "VMware tools". With a wide range of operating system support, they provide you with a seamless experience when working on the virtual machine you created using VMware Workstation. They allow the use of a lot of other features. VMware tools are available for Windows (98, 2000, XP, Vista and 7), Linux (almost every distribution can make use of them), Solaris as well as for the FreeBSD. We don't expect you to miss the Mac here because the Mac OS X wouldn't work on any hardware other than Apple's and VMware doesn't emulate them. So, no Mac support. VMware tools facilitate the use of shared folders and visual glory inside a virtual machine which probably no other virtualization software can provide. As a matter of fact, VMware Workstation is the only virtualization software you can find to support the AERO interface which was brought into Windows Vista and later versions. You may also want to install it if you're going to use any applications inside the virtual OS which require 3D support (e.g. 3D modeling or Google Earth or something else which needs you to have either DirectX or OpenGL support). To